

## Westhampton Public Library Board of Trustees

**Date:** Feb. 10, 2026

**Time:** 6:00pm

Community Room Westhampton Public Library

In-Person Meeting and Zoom

**Present:** Meaghan Schwelm, Angela Griefen, Alison Thirkield, Rick Tracy, Deb Estelle, Jackie Brodeur

**Absent:** Anne Marie O'Reilly

**Call To Order:** 6: 04 pm

Minutes from Last meeting (January, 2026): Move to approve by Jackie Brodeur, seconded by Deb Estelle. Approved unanimously.

Move to approve December 2025 minutes "as corrected," by Rick Tracy, seconded by Deb Estelle. Approved unanimously.

Documents:

Director's Report 2.10.26

FY27 Library budget draft

State Aid Waiver workshop notes from 2.10.26

### Treasurer's Report

**Building:** \$3,594.48

**State Aid:** \$9,621.85

**Deferred Town Monies (expenses):** \$27,317.23

**Deferred Town Monies (salaries):** \$35,571.10

**Gifts:** \$26,982.48

### Director's Report

**Statistics:**

Children's Programs: 11 children's programs with 128 attending

Adult Programs: 19 adult programs with 92 attending

Teen Programs: 1 teen programs with 3 attending

General Audience Programs: 1 general audience programs with 98 attending (Boston Post Cane Ceremony for Jessie Krug)

Circulation: 1,813 (January 2025 -1,820 )

eBooks: 518 (January 2025 – 504 )

Meaghan attended an Age & Dementia Friendly Pioneer Valley webinar, in which she learned of an AARP Community Challenge Grant, which is typically a 12K award. This may provide an

opportunity for the Outdoor Access Committee to pursue a plan for an All Persons picnic area in the library yard. The benefits, questions, and possible next steps of this were discussed. Meaghan will discuss this with the Outdoor Access Committee, and will discuss it with the selectboard if it is determined to make a grant application.

### Friends Report

Meaghan Schwelm informed the Friends about the budget outlook for FY27. They discussed re-introducing the “fill the shelves” category to offset possible cuts in materials budget. The Friends received an anonymous donation of \$25,000.

They are working on the newsletter and annual appeal.

Voted for officers: Jo Martin, President; Anita Goddard, Clerk; Judy Wayne, Treasurer.

### Old Business

Continued to discuss the FY27 Library budget. Meaghan shared information she received at the State Waiver Workshop, an online workshop with Mass Board of Libraries with communities anticipating requesting state aid waivers. Items of note included the waiver process; the increasing MAR requirement each year; inability to use any funds other than those budgeted to the library from the town to meet that requirement; the requirement to meet minimum mandatory purchasing of 18% to qualify for a waiver; scenarios in which staff hours, thus operating hours and some programming may have to be cut, to meet required library targets per MBLC and State Aid requirements, depending on the town’s final budget.

Deb Estelle moved to approve Meaghan submitting this current draft of the FY27 Library budget to the Finance Committee, Angela Griefen seconded. Approved unanimously.

### New Business

It was agreed that after the budget work has been completed, the Trustees will review and update Social Media Policy for the library. Will also further review the library website to assess and improve public access to information.

Move to adjourn by Jackie Brodeur, seconded by Deb Estelle. Approved unanimously.

Any other Business to come before the Trustees, not anticipated at the time of posting of this agenda

**Meeting Adjourned:** 7:20 pm

**Next Meeting:** March 10, 2026, 6:00 p.m.

**Submitted By:** Alison Thirkield